

Saturday, 20 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 25° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Drizzle 24° 17°	MANCHESTER Light rain 22° 17°	GLASGOW Rain 18° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Get ready for a scorching weekend, as an amber extreme heat warning has been issued for parts of the UK.

Temperatures are expected to peak in the mid-30s Celsius on Monday and Tuesday. This heatwave could impact health and potentially disrupt travel across the country.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

In a shocking development, police now believe a three-year-old boy hurt at a zoo was attacked by a crocodile.

A man arrested on suspicion of attempted murder in connection with the incident has since been bailed. Authorities are continuing their investigation into what happened.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Thirty people have been sentenced for their part in the serious disorder that saw a police officer set on fire in Cardiff last year.

The violence erupted in 2023 following the deaths of teenagers Kyrees Sullivan and Harvey Evans. The sentences aim to bring justice for the widespread disruption and harm caused.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Thousands of HGV drivers were given bogus medical tests in the back of vans, according to a new investigation.

Trading Standards revealed that 'Doctors on Wheels' offered tests for 'just under £60', significantly undercutting legitimate competitors. This raises serious concerns about road safety.

CONSUMER · UK
- 5

Scottish guidance on trans prisoners has been ruled unlawful by a judge.

Lady Ross stated that sex segregation in prisons must be based on biological sex, aligning with a Supreme Court ruling from last year. This decision has significant implications for prison policy.

LAW · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Get ready for some serious glamour on the dancefloor, as Kim Kardashian's hair stylist Chris Appleton is set to join the Strictly Come Dancing line-up!**

The British stylist is famous for working with A-listers like Jennifer Lopez, Katy Perry, and Ariana Grande. He's sure to bring some star power to the ballroom.

ON AIR – What kind of moves do you think a celebrity hair stylist will bring to Strictly? Will he be a dark horse?

TV · COMING UP
- 2 UK rapper Megan Da Savage has given a huge shout-out to Linkin Park, saying the band 'changed my life' after Mike Shinoda praised her freestyle.**

Shinoda spotted her rap on an independent music platform, leading to this fantastic moment of recognition. It's a great example of artists supporting each other.

ON AIR – It's always brilliant when established artists champion new talent. What's your favourite example of that happening?

MUSIC · GOOD NEWS
- 3 A new Welsh-language film, 'Effi o Blaenau', is being hailed as a 'sensation' for its blend of tragedy and social realism.**

The film follows a young woman grappling with unemployment in a North Wales town. It's great to see Welsh cinema getting such positive attention.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of films that tackle real-life issues with a touch of drama? What's your favourite 'social realism' movie?

FILM · NEW RELEASE
- 4 The reviews are in for 'Toy Story 5', and while critics are split, most are praising its 'cautionary' message about technology.**

The fifth instalment sees Tom Hanks, Tim Allen, and Joan Cusack all return to their iconic roles. It sounds like it's bringing a timely message to a beloved franchise.

ON AIR – Are you excited for another Toy Story? What's your favourite film in the series so far?

FILM · NEW RELEASE
- 5 The new London Museum Smithfield site is set to open its doors in November, promising a fantastic new cultural experience.**

The building will become the new home for some incredible exhibits, including Banksy's piranhas and the UK's oldest hand-written document. Definitely one for the diary!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual or surprising exhibit you've ever seen at a museum?

CULTURE · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 Scotland's World Cup dreams hang in the balance as they face Morocco in what could be their most important game ever.

A win against Morocco would secure knockout tournament football for the first time in their history. Manager Steve Clarke will be hoping for their best display yet.

ON AIR – How confident are you that Scotland can make history and secure a place in the knockout stages?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 Newly promoted Coventry City face a baptism of fire in the Premier League, kicking off their season against champions Arsenal.

It's a huge opening fixture for Coventry, travelling to the reigning champions in their first match of the 2026-27 season. What a way to start!

ON AIR – What's the toughest opening fixture you can remember for a newly promoted team in the Premier League?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 French tennis player Corentin Moutet has lost almost all his Queen's prize money after being fined \$40,000 for swearing in a live TV interview.

Moutet was penalised for using expletives seven times during the interview. It's a stark reminder of the rules regarding on-air conduct.

ON AIR – Should athletes be fined so heavily for bad language, or is it just part of the heat of the moment?
TENNIS · UK

4 England's Matt Fisher has hit his first Test half-century, batting at number 10 against New Zealand at The Oval.

His impressive fifty helped England reach a score of 291 in their first innings. It was a crucial contribution when the team needed it most.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of a tail-ender coming in and scoring vital runs for England?
CRICKET · UK

5 Former England goalkeeper Mary Earps has joined London City Lionesses on a two-year deal.

Earps makes the move after leaving Paris St-Germain, bringing her wealth of experience to the London club. A big signing for the Lionesses!

ON AIR – What impact do you think a player of Mary Earps' calibre will have on the London City Lionesses?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking up a 'craft' hobby can significantly boost mental well-being.**
Researchers found that activities like knitting, pottery, or model-making provide a sense of accomplishment and focus, helping to reduce everyday stress.
- 2 The trend for 'upcycling old furniture' is soaring, as people transform forgotten pieces into stylish home additions.**
From painting dressers to reupholstering chairs, this eco-friendly trend allows for unique, personalised decor without a hefty price tag.
- 3 Experts are noting a rise in 'community book swaps', where neighbours exchange novels and share recommendations.**
These informal libraries foster local connections and give books a new lease of life, promoting sustainable reading habits.
- 4 New research indicates that regularly listening to 'nature sounds' can improve concentration and lower anxiety.**
Whether it's the gentle pitter-patter of rain or the distant chirping of birds, these ambient noises create a calming background for daily tasks.
- 5 There's a growing interest in 'retro video game nights', as friends gather to relive classic gaming console memories.**
From iconic platformers to early racing games, these evenings offer a fun, nostalgic escape and friendly competition.
- 6 A study highlights the positive impact of 'volunteering with animals' on emotional health.**
Spending time with shelter pets or assisting at wildlife rescues provides companionship and a sense of purpose, benefiting both humans and creatures.
- 7 The popularity of 'themed picnic baskets' is on the rise for outdoor dining.**
Families and friends are curating baskets with specific culinary themes, from 'Mediterranean delights' to 'British cream tea', making al fresco meals an event.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 50% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what to a packet of biscuits before anyone else gets to them?

ANSWER: LOOKING FOR THE BIGGEST OR BEST-FROSTED ONE.

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'moment of quiet' instantly recharges their batteries. What came out on top?

ANSWER: THE FIRST SIP OF A HOT CUP OF TEA OR COFFEE IN THE MORNING.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a new 'short cut' or a clever 'hack' that just makes a household chore so much easier?

What's your go-to trick or tip that saves you time or effort around the house? We'd love to hear your ingenious solutions!

- We all have those certain 'little joys' that just instantly brighten our day, don't we? Things that might seem small, but mean a lot to us.

What's an unexpected 'little joy' that recently brought a smile to your face? Share your moment of everyday happiness!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's true that butterflies only live for one day and spend their entire short life fluttering around a single flower.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.46 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The world's largest desert is not hot; it's the Antarctic Polar Desert, which covers most of the continent.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one-hundredth of a second.
- Wombat poo is cube-shaped, which helps it to not roll away and mark their territory effectively.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 to 45 minutes.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the known universe.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- Snails can sleep for up to three years, waiting for the right environmental conditions.

On this day

Day 171 of the year, 194 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Adalbert of Magdeburg; Christian feast day: Blessed Dermot O'Hurley; Christian feast day: Florentina; Christian feast day: John of Matera. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1949 — Lionel Richie, American singer, songwriter, pianist, producer, and actor
- 1978 — Quinton Jackson, American mixed martial artist and actor
- 1954 — Michael Anthony, American musician
- 1973 — Chino Moreno, American singer, guitarist and lyricist
- 1941 — Stephen Frears, English actor, director, and producer
- 1956 — Peter Reid, English footballer and manager
- 1939 — Budge Rogers, English rugby player and manager
- 1967 — Dan Tyminski, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — ABC News correspondent Bill Stewart is shot dead by a Nicaraguan National Guard soldier under the regime of Anastasio Somoza Debayle during the Nicaraguan Revolution. The murder is caught on tape and sparks an international outcry against the regime.
- 1956 — A Venezuelan Super-Constellation crashes in the Atlantic Ocean off Asbury Park, New Jersey, killing 74 people.
- 1973 — Aeroméxico Flight 229 crashes on approach to Licenciado Gustavo Díaz Ordaz International Airport, killing all 27 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — The Mali Federation gains independence from France (it later splits into Mali and Senegal).
- 1982 — The Argentine Corbeta Uruguay base on Southern Thule surrenders to Royal Marine commandos in the final action of the Falklands War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1994 — The 1994 Imam Reza shrine bomb explosion in Iran leaves at least 25 dead and 70 to 300 injured.
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1944 — The experimental MW 18014 V-2 rocket reaches an altitude of 176 km, becoming the first man-made object to reach outer space.

- 2019 — Iran's Air Defense Forces shoot down an American surveillance drone over the Strait of Hormuz amid rising tensions between the two countries.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 172 of the year, 193 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alban of Mainz; Christian feast day: Aloysius Gonzaga; Christian feast day: Engelmund of Velsen; Christian feast day: John Rigby. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Michael Gross, American actor
- 1964 — Doug Savant, American actor
- 1967 — Jim Breuer, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1940 — Mariette Hartley, American actress and television personality
- 1964 — David Morrissey, English actor and director
- 1959 — Kathy Mattea, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1948 — Ian McEwan, British novelist and screenwriter
- 1950 — Joey Kramer, American rock drummer and songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1973 — The Primer Congreso del Hombre Andino is inaugurated in Arica, Chile.
- 2000 — Section 28 (of the Local Government Act 1988), outlawing the 'promotion' of homosexuality in the United Kingdom, is repealed in Scotland with a 99 to 17 vote.
- 1945 — World War II: The Battle of Okinawa ends when the organized resistance of Imperial Japanese Army forces collapses in the Mabuni area on the southern tip of the main island.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1978 — The original production of Tim Rice and Andrew Lloyd Webber's musical, Evita, based on the life of Eva Perón, opens at the Prince Edward Theatre, London.
- 1989 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules in Texas v. Johnson, 491 U.S. 397, that American flag-burning is a form of political protest protected by the First Amendment.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)